

The Courier

Genre: Action Thriller

Age Range: 18-25

Characters

ETHAN (23) - A bike courier who just wants to finish his shift and get paid.

LENA (22) - Ethan's friend, a journalism student who believes the package contains evidence of a major crime.

LENA: Tell me you didn't open it.

ETHAN: I opened it.

LENA: Ethan!

ETHAN: Relax. I was curious.

LENA: That's exactly why I told you not to open it.

ETHAN: In my defense, it was making a weird rattling sound.

LENA: That's not a defense.

ETHAN: It's a pretty good defense.

LENA: What did you see?

ETHAN: A flash drive.

LENA: That's all?

ETHAN: And about a hundred files with names that sound extremely illegal.

LENA: Let me see.

ETHAN: No.

LENA: Ethan.

ETHAN: Every time somebody says my full name like that, my life gets worse.

LENA: Give me the drive.

ETHAN: Why?

LENA: Because if I'm right, this could expose half the city council.

ETHAN: Great.

LENA: Great?

ETHAN: No, not great. Terrible. Horrible. Catastrophic. Do you know what I deliver for a living?

LENA: Packages.

ETHAN: Exactly. Packages. Not government conspiracies.

LENA: Somebody trusted you with it.

ETHAN: I think somebody accidentally handed it to me.

LENA: Doesn't matter.

ETHAN: It matters to me.

LENA: Ethan, people could be getting hurt.

ETHAN: And people could hurt us.

(beat)

LENA: You're scared.

ETHAN: Of course I'm scared.

LENA: Good.

ETHAN: Good?

LENA: Fear means you understand the risk.

ETHAN: I understand it perfectly.

LENA: Then help me do something about it.

ETHAN: Why is it always us?

LENA: Because nobody else is here.

(Ethan looks at the drive.)

ETHAN: If we do this, there's no turning back.

LENA: I know.

ETHAN: We could get arrested.

LENA: I know.

ETHAN: Followed.

LENA: Probably.

ETHAN: That's not comforting.

LENA: I wasn't trying to comfort you.

(Ethan laughs despite himself.)

ETHAN: You're impossible.

LENA: Yet you're still here.

(beat)

ETHAN: Yeah.

(He pockets the drive.)

ETHAN: Guess we're doing this.

LENA: Together?

ETHAN: Together.

BLACKOUT